

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations, Threat Hunting, Detection Engineering,
Incident Response

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Operations, Incident Response, and Defensive Operations. I have deep proficiency in Microsoft Sentinel, including Kusto Query Language (KQL) query development, analytics rule authoring, and workbook creation, as well as in Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), covering Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and the wider Microsoft 365 Defender suite. I conduct advanced investigations including root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation, and I lead proactive threat hunting campaigns grounded in the MITRE ATT&CK framework and threat intelligence. I convert hunt findings and incident learnings directly into detection rules and tuning recommendations, closing gaps in the detection estate. With experience managing security tooling configuration and operation across an 8,000-user enterprise, I am comfortable owning the technical delivery of defensive security processes and driving continuous improvement. I am looking to bring this expertise to a Defensive Operations team where I can protect people, systems, and data at scale.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** KQL query development, analytics rules, workbooks, watchlists, incident management, connector configuration, Log Analytics workspace management
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, advanced hunting, alert tuning, incident investigation
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven and intelligence-led hunting, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, behavioural analytics, converting findings into detection rules or tuning recommendations
- **Incident Response:** Full incident lifecycle management (detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned), NIST Special Publication 800-61, root cause analysis
- **Detection Engineering:** SIEM use case development, analytics rule creation, alert tuning, false positive reduction, Sigma rule concepts
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, Discover, threat hunting via Falcon OverWatch
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus, risk-based prioritisation
- **SOAR and Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) playbook development, PowerShell scripting, automation workflows
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Own the technical configuration, maintenance, and operation of the Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and security tooling estate, ensuring defensive controls operate effectively across an 8,000-user environment.
- Lead investigation of advanced security incidents escalated from initial triage, conducting full root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation following the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 incident response framework.

- Develop and maintain Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, detection queries, and workbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, continuously improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates.
- Operate Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), managing alert investigation, threat containment, and remediation workflows.
- Design and execute proactive threat hunting campaigns using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, analysing endpoint, identity, email, and network telemetry to surface adversary activity prior to alert escalation.
- Convert threat hunt findings and incident learnings into new detection rules, analytics use cases, or tuning recommendations, closing gaps in the organisation's detection estate.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), managing detection policies, custom alert rules, and hunting queries to maximise endpoint visibility and response capability.
- Develop Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell and automation workflows to streamline alert enrichment, triage, and response actions.
- Manage Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Entra ID), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access and reduce identity-based attack surface.
- Oversee the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), aligning remediation priorities to risk and threat intelligence.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) **Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity**

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts across SIEM and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms, conducting initial investigation and escalating incidents through defined response procedures.
- Supported the full incident response lifecycle including detection, containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting, contributing to lessons-learned reviews and detection improvements.
- Developed and tuned SIEM detection use cases and analytics rules, working with the security team to reduce alert fatigue and improve signal quality.
- Conducted threat hunting activities across endpoint, identity, and email telemetry, using behavioural analytics and known adversary techniques to surface threats not caught by automated alerting.
- Performed vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus, analysing results, prioritising findings by risk, and tracking remediation through to closure with infrastructure teams.
- Administered Microsoft Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access policies, and Identity Protection features, supporting the organisation's identity security posture.
- Produced security reports, metrics dashboards, and incident summaries for IT leadership, translating technical findings into clear, actionable information for stakeholders at all levels.

HEX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) **Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure**

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, applying ISO 27001 principles and aligning with industry security frameworks.
- Monitored security events and responded to incidents, supporting initial triage and escalation in line with company security procedures.
- Managed endpoint security and identity access controls, ensuring device compliance and enforcing access policies across the organisation.
- Supported Microsoft Azure cloud infrastructure security, monitoring for misconfigurations and enforcing access policies through Azure Active Directory.
- Contributed to vulnerability assessments and security quality assurance testing, identifying risks and coordinating remediation with development and infrastructure teams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and delivered a library of custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, significantly improving detection coverage for high-priority attack techniques across the enterprise.

- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) across an 8,000-user estate, materially reducing mean time to detect and mean time to respond.
- Developed and executed a programme of threat hunting campaigns aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactic and technique gaps, each hunt resulting in actionable detection improvements or confirmed security posture validation.
- Built and operationalised Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell automation, reducing manual analyst effort in alert triage and enabling faster, more consistent incident response.
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across the university, eliminating the use of shared administrative credentials and significantly reducing the organisation's exposure to credential-based attack paths.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate control effectiveness, directly informing detection engineering priorities and demonstrating measurable improvement in security posture over time.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)